

Dark meat seitan

If you are making Udon Noodles with Seitan, Crispy Sweet and Hot Orange Seitan, Savory Seitan Strips, or Seitan à la Bourguignonne, prepare your Basic Dough, wrap it, and cook it in this highly seasoned braising liquid that will flavor the dough as it cooks.

The flavors in this braising liquid are rich, **savory**, and a touch smoky. There is enough liquid to cook one batch of Basic Seitan Dough.

2 tablespoons olive oil

2 tablespoons red miso

2 tablespoons molasses

2 tablespoons tomato paste

1 tablespoon soy sauce

1 tablespoon balsamic vinegar

4 garlic cloves, minced

1 tablespoon dried basil

1 tablespoon dried oregano

2 teaspoons paprika

2 teaspoons salt

1 teaspoon whole peppercorns

1 heaping teaspoon onion powder

¼ teaspoon cayenne powder

1 cup port or Madeira [250ml]

5 cups vegetable stock [1.25L]

5 cups water [1.25L]

Uncooked prepared dough from Basic Seitan Recipe (page 230), wrapped according to recipe directions

1. In a medium bowl, **mix** together the olive oil, miso, molasses, tomato paste, soy sauce, balsamic vinegar, and garlic into a paste. Add the basil, oregano, paprika, salt, peppercorns, and onion powder. Stir to blend. Set the paste aside.
2. In a large nonreactive pot, **combine** the wine, vegetable stock, and water. Bring to a boil. Ladle about 1 cup [250ml] of the hot liquid into the seasoning paste. Stir until well incorporated. Stir everything back into the pot and return to a boil.
3. Place the wrapped seitan packages in the pot and **reduce** the heat to a simmer. Partially cover the pot with a lid and cook for 1 hour.
4. Use tongs to **turn** the seitan over so all sides get adequately exposed to the braising liquid. Continue to cook for another 1 to 1½ hours. (The longer you cook the

meat, the firmer it will become; at any point after 1½ hours total you may remove the seitan from the liquid and unwrap it to check out the taste and firmness and decide whether you want to continue cooking.) If you see that the liquid has evaporated and more than half of the seitan is exposed, add an additional 1 to 2 cups [250 to 500ml] stock. The seitan will be firm after braising, but it will continue to firm up in the refrigerator overnight.

5. Let cool, remove the string (if using) and cheesecloth, and **slice** the seitan into rounds ½ inch [1cm] thick or cut into other desired shapes (such as dice, fingers, or thin strips) and proceed with the recipe of your choice.
6. **Store** dark meat seitan in the refrigerator, completely immersed in the braising liquid and well sealed, for up to 3 days.

